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MY POWAI

Volume No. 14 Issue No. 03 Mumbai November 2025

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Dear friends

Dassera and Diwali have passed, leaving behind the familiar sparkle of lights and laughter. Now, as we wait patiently for winter to set in, there's a gentle calm in the air — that little pause before the year begins to wind down and Christmas cheer takes over.

This month, Chef Sudhir Pai tempts us with some delicious vegetarian dishes that even the most dedicated non-vegetarians might want to try!

Our nutritionist shares four simple foods that are great for your gut — timely advice as we move into the cooler months.

You'll also find astro predictions as we approach the end of the year — always an interesting read as we look back on what's gone by and ahead to what's coming.

And don't miss our feature on Dr. Neeraj Tulara's Bookurdoc, a thoughtful new healthcare initiative launched right here in Powai. It promises to make life easier for residents of Powai and Chandivali.

As always, we'd love to stay connected with you. Follow My Powai on Instagram and X for the latest updates, stories, and glimpses of our vibrant community.

Warm regards,
Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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If you see or experience any act of injustice in our locality please report to us: mypowai@yahoo.in

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Speed breakers in Powai have become back-breakers



D.P.K. Udas

Powai has an ample population of vehicles. At any given point of the day or night, there is a traffic jam. Vehicles move at a very slow pace. In spite of this, an ample number of Speed Breakers (SB) are erected.

Number of speed breakers

- Powai Plaza to SM Shetty School: 14
- Powai Plaza to Galleria: 5
- Hiranandani School to Hospital:12
- Hiranandani School – Nahar School: 15

Indian Road Congress (IRC)

IRC have laid standards for Speed Breakers.

- The distance between two Speed Breakers should be at least 120 m.

However, this is not followed here, and SBs are erected at much shorter spans.

- The center height of a Speed Breaker should not exceed 0.1 m (10 cm).

This is 1/3rd of a foot. However, in reality, much higher SBs are erected.

- The width of a hump should be 3.7 m.

The vehicle should rise with a 1:20 ratio, travel straight, and then slide down smoothly. In actual practice, much less width is provided. This causes a jerk in the vehicle.

Marking

Speed Breakers should be painted with black and white paint. They should also have luminous strips. In reality, the paint gets washed out, and luminous strips are never provided. At night, it is difficult to see the Speed Breaker, and passengers jump up to the ceiling.

Warning Signs

There should be warning signs "Speed Breaker Ahead" or "Gati Rodhak Pudhe Aahe." These should be placed 40 m before the Speed Breaker. In Powai, there are no signs. If placed, 50 boards will come up.

It is better to place one big sign at the entry of Powai:

"There is a road in between Speed Breakers."



Types of Speed Breakers

There are different types of Speed Breakers, and Powai has all of them.

Normal Speed Breaker

This is made on tar roads and has a slope on either side. It tends to get partially washed away during monsoon and requires repairs. Still, it is the best option.

Rubber Speed Breakers

These are easy to install and can be done quickly without much interruption to traffic. They can take a load of up to 30 MT.

PVC Speed Breakers

These are similar to rubber SBs but made of PVC material. Available in yellow and black colors, they are fire-retardant and do not get damaged in case of fire.

Plastic Speed Breakers

They are made of heavy-duty plastic and have rumblers on the top.

Polymer Speed Breakers

They are made of Acrylonitrile Butadiene Styrene (ABS) thermoplastic polymer. They can take loads up to 100 MT.

Innovations at Powai

Use of concrete humps as Speed Breakers

Many road contractors or civil contractors are using these. The concrete hump is made and allowed to cure. Needless to say, they are not able to adhere to IRC guidelines.

Speed Breakers with paver blocks

Speed Breakers are made with paver blocks on top. These can also be used by pedestrians to cross the road.

Accidents Due to Speed Breakers

Motorcycle toppling

Many motorcyclists are not in a position to judge the bump and tend to topple.

Sliding back

Many vehicles tend to slide back due to steep slopes and touch the vehicle behind. Then starts the road rage, causing further traffic interruption. This is particularly true for auto-rickshaws that have limited power and are unable to hold on the slope of an SB.

Now the matter is taken up with the BMC Roads Department and Traffic Department. An audit of the numerous Speed Breakers in Powai needs to be undertaken. Those that are not required should be removed. IRC standards must be followed for those that remain.

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



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Giant Metro 2025 joins Federation 1B picnic at Fountain Water Resort

- Preeti Oka



It was a bright Sunday morning when the Giant Metro 2025 members set out for a much-awaited Federation 1B picnic at Fountain Water Resort, Palghar. Planned after the monsoon, the idea was simple — to soak in nature's freshness and spend a day filled with laughter, music, and good company.

The AC bus began its journey at 7:30 a.m. with a cheerful "Ganpati Bappa Morya!" reverberating through the air. Having already picked up members from the Powai centre, the bus made a brief halt at Thane to gather more excited faces. With sparse Sunday traffic and rolling green hills on either side, the drive itself felt like a prelude to the fun that awaited.

After about an hour and a half, the group reached the resort — a sprawling property buzzing with music, chatter, and the promise of a perfect day. Members from the Ghatkopar centre arrived in another bus, and soon everyone was sporting colourful wristbands that marked their group identity.

A hearty breakfast set the tone for the day. Then began the real adventure — water rides of every kind imaginable! Showers that poured like barrels from above, slides that twisted and turned before ending in a big splash, and a wave pool that gave the feel of river rafting. Laughter echoed all around as people relived their childhood joy. Lifeguards, ever watchful, ensured everyone's safety as the fun continued.

The poolside soon turned into a dance floor as music took over and people grooved with carefree smiles. Cameras clicked away, capturing memories that would last long after the day was over.

By lunchtime, appetites had grown, and the delicious spread was a treat to everyone's taste buds. After lunch, the group gathered in the hall for a karaoke session. Some relaxed on the provided mattresses, while others sang their hearts out — from soulful melodies to foot-tapping numbers, the talent on display was impressive!

A fun movie-song quiz followed, with prizes given out to winners from different groups. As the evening sun mellowed, snacks were served, wrapping up the day on a sweet note.

Before departure, organiser Jitendra Khakkar extended heartfelt thanks to Federation 1B President Mr. Vishvamitra Bherwani, Mr. Kini, and Mr. Satish Algar for their constant support in making the event such a wonderful success.

Giant Metro 2025 continues to actively participate in various events organised by Giant Federation 1B, bringing members together through shared joy and community spirit.

To join the group, contact President Sharda Das at 99675 56421.

A slice of Bengal in Chandivali

— Tonmoy Gope



The Bengali community in Chandivali — and particularly in Nahar — came together to celebrate বিজয়া দশমী (Vijaya Dashami) in an intimate gathering at the Lilium Lantana community hall on the 12th of October. Much like Deepavali, Vijaya Dashami is a time for Bengalis to visit friends and family, exchange greetings, and seek the blessings of elders.

In a fast-paced metro where ringing your neighbour's doorbell has become almost old-fashioned, this celebration was a heartfelt effort to bring the small community together — to meet, greet, and reconnect. The evening offered the perfect opportunity for some quintessential "adda" over tea, singara (Bengali samosa), and mishti (sweets), as per Bengali tradition.

The event saw a lively turnout of over 85 people, including many recent entrants to Chandivali who were delighted to discover a vibrant Bengali community in their neighbourhood. Dressed in traditional attire, attendees enjoyed jhal muri, fuchka (pani puri), rolls, cutlets, and biryani — keeping spirits high and taste buds happy.

And of course, you can never keep Bengalis away from music. A few soulful songs were sung, an enthusiastic round of antakshari followed, and conversations over steaming cups of tea soon turned to plans for a community picnic. There were also spirited discussions about organizing a Saraswati Puja — and even the dream of hosting a Durga Puja next year.

Members returned home with full hearts and smiling faces, having shared an evening that brought a little bit of Bengal to Chandivali.

Subho Bijoya and Happy Kali Pujo to all our readers!



The Comfort of Knowing Income Will Always Come Home

Systematic Withdrawal Plan for Dignified & Dependable Retirement Income

In our previous issues of My Powai, we discussed how **Annuities** offer a guaranteed monthly income for life, and how **REITs** help you earn from real estate without owning property.

This month, we explore another powerful retirement income strategy — the **Systematic Withdrawal Plan (SWP)** through mutual funds.

What is an SWP?

An SWP allows you to withdraw a fixed amount from your mutual fund at regular intervals — monthly, quarterly, or yearly — while the rest of your money stays invested and continues to grow.

It works like a pension created by you… flexible, tax-efficient, and designed around your lifestyle.

Why should retirees consider SWP?

✔ monthly income to meet expenses
✔ investments that keep growing
✔ protection from rising inflation

SWP helps you achieve all three.

If you start SWP **after retirement,** your savings don't just sit idle — they continue to earn returns. That helps your income **keep pace with inflation,** unlike traditional fixed deposits where the interest remains the same.

The Key Rule:

Your withdrawals should be lower than your investment returns.

Why?

So that your capital remains intact for future years and continues to generate income.

That's what makes retirement income predictable and sustainable.



How much can you withdraw safely?

Investor Type	Suggested Annual Withdrawal Rate	Goal
Conservative	~4% of the corpus	Preserve capital long-term
Moderate	5%–6% of the corpus	Bal. growth + income

✔ Reviewing your withdrawal rate every year is important
✔ When markets perform well, you may allow slight increases
✔ During not low return years, reduce withdrawals to protect capital

This methodical approach keeps your money working for you — not the other way around!

Final Thought

Retirement is not about slowing down — it's about living with confidence.

SWP helps transform your savings into a steady, inflation-beating income that supports travel, leisure, family, and peace of mind.

Your life's efforts deserve a plan that keeps you independent and financially secure — year after year.

Retirement SWP requires methodical planning to ensure a predictable income that keeps pace with inflation.

- Uma Kumaravelan
Certified Financial Planner
www.oaktree.in



Bookurdoc: Dr. Tulara's new-age healthcare hub



Dr. Neeraj Tulara
Founder – Bookurdoc

Dr. Neeraj Tulara is a respected physician and infectious disease specialist who served for many years at Dr. L H Hiranandani Hospital, Powai. Known for his expertise, compassion and patient-first approach, he played a key role during the COVID-19 pandemic. Recently, he began a new chapter as the founder of Bookurdoc, a healthcare initiative aimed at making quality medical consultations more accessible and efficient for patients everywhere.

My Powai (MP): Dr. Tulara, congratulations on launching bookurdoc! Can you tell us what inspired you to start this multi-specialty OPD clinic in Powai?

Dr. Neeraj Tulara (DNT): With over 20 years of experience as a practicing physician in some of the country's leading corporate hospitals, I have had the privilege of interacting with thousands of patients. Through these interactions, one thing became increasingly clear: patients long for a healthcare experience that is effective, compassionate, and comfortable — without the intimidating atmosphere of a traditional hospital.

Driven by this insight and years of patient feedback, we set out to create something different — a multispeciality OPD centre that brings together top-notch medical expertise under one roof, while offering an environment that feels welcoming, calm, and non-hospital-like.

This centre is designed with you — the patient — at the heart of everything we do. From the ambience to the ease of access to specialists across disciplines, every aspect of this centre has been thoughtfully crafted to deliver exceptional care in a space that puts you at ease.

Because for us, patient satisfaction isn't just a goal — it's our foundation.

MP: What sets bookurdoc apart from other clinics in the area? How is it different in terms of patient experience and medical services?

DNT: Bookurdoc is a self-sufficient, integrated medical centre designed to deliver comprehensive medical solutions across all specialty and super-specialty fields—without the hassle of long queues, crowded OPDs, or the typical hospital environment. Our centre is thoughtfully created to provide a positive, uplifting space where patients can access top-quality care without being surrounded by sickness or stress.

In today's healthcare landscape, patients often have to choose between small, scattered individual clinics and large, impersonal corporate hospitals. Bookurdoc bridges this gap by offering the expertise and advanced facilities of a hospital with the convenience, comfort, and efficiency of a standalone clinic—all under one roof.

We focus exclusively on non-emergency medical services, ensuring patients receive the highest level of care without the chaos of emergency departments. From expert consultations in various specialties and super-specialties to diagnostics, pharmacy, laboratory, and day-care treatment services, everything is seamlessly integrated to enhance patient experience and outcomes.

Bookurdoc isn't just a clinic or a hospital—it's a smarter way to experience healthcare.

MP: You have over two decades of experience in treating infections, diabetes, and more. How has that shaped your vision for this clinic?

DNT: After working closely with patients for over two decades, we've come to understand something deeply valuable — what patients truly need, what they expect, and what they often don't get in today's healthcare environment.

The concept behind Bookurdoc was born entirely from real feedback, real concerns, and real suggestions from patients. This initiative is not a business model — it's a response to a genuine need in the community.

It is your voices, your trust, and your experiences that shaped Bookurdoc into what it is today. We listened and we acted.

MP: The clinic hosts a wide range of medical specialists. Could you share what kind of specialists patients can expect to find at bookurdoc?

DNT: At Bookurdoc, we offer a comprehensive range of medical and surgical specialties, ensuring that patients receive complete care — from routine consultations to advanced surgical interventions.

Our services cover specialties such as:

- General Medicine & Surgery
- Gynecology & Obstetrics
- Pediatrics
- Orthopedics
- Dermatology
- IVF & Fertility Services
- Nephrology
- Advanced Diagnostics & Imaging

We also offer access to super-specialty services, including:

- Liver Transplant
- Cardiac Transplant
- Onco-Surgery
- And many more high-end specialties

What makes us truly unique is that expert consultants from across Mumbai — including those affiliated with leading corporate hospitals — regularly visit our center to provide their specialized consultations. This means patients don't need to travel far or wait long to access some of the best minds in medicine, right here in their own neighborhood.

MP: Maintaining hygiene and patient safety has become more important than ever. What measures has bookurdoc taken to ensure a safe and hygienic environment?

DNT: As a former Director of Critical Care at one of the leading corporate hospitals in Mumbai, I have always understood the critical importance of hygiene, safety, and patient-centered care.

Since moving to Powai in 2013 and starting my independent practice, my goal has been to bring world-class healthcare standards to the community — with a strong focus on infection control, operational transparency, and clinical excellence.

At Bookurdoc, we've designed an ultra-modern, state-of-the-art medical centre that feels nothing like a traditional clinic. From the moment you walk in, you'll experience an environment that is calm, clean, and welcoming — because we believe healing begins the moment you arrive.

We strictly follow international standard operating protocols (SOPs) for outpatient care, with a particular emphasis on hygiene and infection control, which remains one of the most important (and often neglected) aspects of healthcare facilities worldwide.

Our center is led by a team of seasoned healthcare professionals with over two decades of experience in managing medical colleges and top-tier corporate hospitals across Mumbai.

Our leadership team includes experts with the highest academic qualifications in hospital administration including Master's and PhDs ensuring that every aspect of patient care, operations, and clinical governance is handled professionally, ethically, and efficiently.

We are not here to experiment but we are

contd on Pg 07

contd from page 6

here to deliver uncompromising quality in everything we do. At Bookurdoc, we leave no stone unturned to ensure our patients receive the best care possible.

My Powai (MP): How important is technology in delivering outpatient care today, and how is bookurdoc leveraging it?

DNT: At Bookurdoc, we believe that great healthcare should be accessible, efficient, and patient-friendly. That's why we've integrated the latest technology into every aspect of how we run and manage our centre.

Our operations are supported and managed by a team with expertise from IIT Bombay, ensuring a robust, secure, and seamless experience for both patients and healthcare providers.

To make it easy for our patients to connect with us, we offer:

- A fully functional website for real-time appointment booking
- A dedicated mobile app available on both Android and Apple App Store
- A verified Google Business page with directions, contact details, and updates
- Integration with multiple medical partner platforms for added convenience
- A 24/7 medical hotline, in addition to our landline and appointment booking numbers, so patients can reach us anytime for support

We've designed our system to ensure that no patient faces any difficulty when trying to access our services — whether it's booking an appointment, seeking medical advice, or following up after a consultation.

MP: Can you walk us through the typical patient journey—from booking an appointment to meeting the doctor and follow-ups?

DNT: At our facility, we prioritize patient convenience and care at every step. Booking an appointment is simple and flexible:

- Call Us: Patients can book appointments by calling any of our landline, hotline, or mobile numbers.
- Online Booking: Appointments can be scheduled in real time through our official website, with secure online payment options available via multiple payment gateways.
- Mobile App: Our mobile application, available on both the Google Play Store and Apple App Store, allows patients to book appointments with our expert consultants at their convenience.
- Walk-ins Welcome: For those unable to book in advance, we also accept walk-in patients with minimal waiting time.

On Your Visit

Once a patient arrives:

- They are greeted by our trained receptionist, who is a qualified hospital management graduate.
- The receptionist guides them to the respective doctor's cabin for consultation.
- After the consultation, the receptionist assists the patient in:
  - Understanding the prescription
  - Accessing laboratory tests
  - Utilizing diagnostic services
  - Procuring medicines from our in-house pharmacy

During their stay, patients can relax in our comfortable lounge area, where our team ensures they are well taken care of.

If a patient requires further consultation with another specialist, we guide and assist them accordingly.

MP: With Powai growing as a residential and commercial hub, how do you see bookurdoc serving the community in both preventive and curative healthcare?

DNT: As part of our mission to serve the broader community, we are also launching a series of community outreach programs, tailored for different specialties and population groups. These initiatives aim to:

- Raise health awareness
- Promote preventive care
- Provide early diagnosis and intervention
- Support underserved populations in nearby localities

Whether through health camps, educational sessions, screenings, or specialist consultations, our goal is to make quality healthcare accessible, inclusive, and impactful for all those living in our vicinity.

MP: Are there any plans to expand the services in the future—such as diagnostics, telemedicine, or wellness programs?

DNT: Our offerings include:

- Laboratory Services
- In-house Pharmacy
- Advanced Diagnostic Services
- Telemedicine Consultations
- Home Care & Nursing Services
- Day Care & Outpatient Therapy Services

These services are designed to provide holistic and accessible care whether within our facility or at the patient's doorstep.

Introducing: Doctor Visits at Home – A Unique Care Initiative

With over 20 years of experience in patient care, we've recognized a critical gap in healthcare access for senior citizens and individuals unable to travel to a medical facility. To bridge this gap, we've launched a unique and compassionate program: Doctor Visits at Home.

This service is specially designed to:

- Provide personalized medical care at home for elderly patients and those with mobility challenges.
- Allow patients to consult their preferred specialist from the comfort of their home.
- Ensure continuity of care without compromising on quality or clinical standards.

Patients or family members can book a doctor visit at home simply by calling our dedicated helpline. Our goal is to deliver hospital-quality care at home — with dignity, respect, and a personal touch.

MP: Lastly, what message would you like to give to the people of Powai about their health and how bookurdoc aims to support them in staying healthy?

DNT: Bookurdoc is led by a team of seasoned healthcare professionals who have been serving in this field for over two decades. What sets us apart is the trust we've built through our honest, unbiased, and patient-centric approach to medical care. In a time when commercial interests often overshadow patient well-being, we remain firmly committed to one core principle: We do not believe in unnecessary tests or treatments. Our only goal is to ensure that every patient receives the right care, at the right time, from the right expert.

To everyone in Powai and surrounding areas — if you or your loved ones need any form of medical assistance, just give us a call.

Whether it's:

- Booking a consultation
- Home visit by a doctor
- Diagnostic support
- Pharmacy or lab services
- Or even just medical guidance

We invite you to experience our state-of-the-art center, designed to provide modern care with a human touch.For emergency situations, patients will be promptly and respectfully referred to nearby hospitals of their choice for appropriate and timely care.

We are here when you need us — with trust, transparency, and total commitment to your health.

Embracing the empty nest - transforming emptiness into new beginnings



Debika Chaudhuri

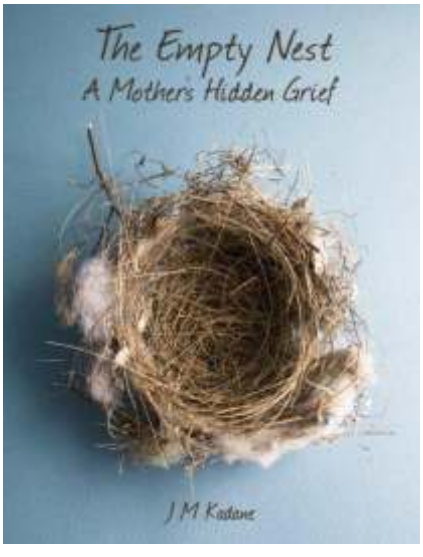
Imagine a lighthouse keeper whose primary mission is to keep the beacon glowing through the darkest nights so ships can find their way to shore. For years, this purpose gives structure to her days and meaning to her solitude. But over time, the storms grow harsher, the machinery rusts, and fewer ships seem to pass. The keeper starts to wonder, "does the light even matter anymore?" Slowly, she stops polishing the lens, the wick burns unevenly, and the glow weakens. Without realizing it, the keeper's neglect allows the very storms she was meant to guide others through to take over her mind.

I have met many women, who have this vast sense of emptiness once her children leave home for college, careers, or their own families. Suddenly, the once-busy household is quiet; routines vanish. This shift can feel like the storms for the lighthouse keeper, everything familiar is changed, the machinery begins to "rust," and she wonders if the light she kept burning still matters.

This is how **erosion of purpose** happens to us in real life. When we lose sight of why we do what we do, our inner beacon starts dimming. The noise of daily survival, personal shifts, or personal loss feels like saltwater slowly corroding the metal of our motivation impacting our mental health.

Step-by-Step Impact on Mental Health and Emotions

1. **Disconnection:**
The first sign is subtle, work or routine starts to feel mechanical. What once inspired energy now feels emotionally flat. The individual starts saying, "I don't feel like myself anymore."
2. **Conflicting thoughts:**
A gap emerges between one's values and one's actions. The mind feels pulled between doing what's required and what feels meaningful. This tension breeds confusion, frustration, and guilt.
3. **Emotional Exhaustion:**
Drained by constant internal conflict, the person starts feeling emotionally tired. Even rest doesn't feel refreshing because the exhaustion is purpose-related, not physical.
4. **Loss of Self-Efficacy:** The belief in "I can make a difference" weakens. This erodes self-confidence and amplifies feelings of helplessness or inadequacy.
5. **Anxiety and Withdrawal:** The uncertainty about direction triggers anxiety, while disinterest in meaningful engagement leads to isolation or detachment from peers and relationships.
6. **Resignation or Cynicism:** Eventually, the protective mechanism of detachment takes over an emotional numbness that masks pain with indifference. The person might speak cynically about work, people, or their own dreams.



Renewing the Light

Just as a lighthouse keeper must rediscover the value of his beacon, a woman can slowly find new meaning and direction. The journey is a gradual process, she may reflect, grieve, and then begin to nurture new passions or relationships. With time and intentional care, her light can shine for herself and others in new ways, marking a fresh chapter beyond motherhood.

Steps to Renew the Light

- **Acknowledge Your Feelings**

Allow yourself to feel and express emotions, sadness, worry, and grief are normal. Name these feelings and talk them through with a trusted friend, partner, or counselor.

- **Maintain a Routine**

Structure helps restore a sense of control. Continue or create new daily rituals, such as morning walks, meal planning, or regular check-ins with loved ones.

- **Invest in Yourself**

Start a new hobby, return to past passions, or embark on a small adventure or project. Learning, creativity, and self-development can reignite your sense of purpose.

- **Increase Social Connection**

Deepen relationships with friends, family, or groups. Reconnect with your spouse and make new friends, social support is key to reducing isolation and renewing emotional energy.

- **Practice Physical Activity and Mindfulness**

Regular movement (walking, yoga, swimming) lifts mood and reduces anxiety. Mindfulness, meditation, or breathing exercises can calm your mind and help you stay grounded.

- **Set Realistic Personal Goals**

Establish meaningful goals, whether pursuing work, further study, travel, or volunteering. Break these into small, manageable steps for a sense of achievement and direction.

- **Seek Professional Support If Needed**

If feelings of depression or anxiety persist, reach out to a mental health professional. Therapy, support groups, or counseling can provide strategies and support to navigate big transitions.

These steps help renew your emotional "light," making space for self-discovery, growth, new relationships, and a vibrant sense of purpose beyond the roles you held before.

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debikac@elzixfoundation.com)

Diwali, one lungful at a time



Chaarvi Athawale

Every Diwali, Powai transforms. The fairy lights come out, adorning balconies with their soft hue, while every building fights for a spot for the prettiest façade. Psychedelic rangoli patterns at doorsteps, made with dexterous and loving hands, await the arrival of guests laden with sweets and warm festive greetings. By evening, the town looks like a wedding, one where everyone's invited and no one's coordinating. There's an energy in the air. And also, unfortunately, a lot of air in the air.

Because soon after the lamps are lit, the rockets arrive. It starts innocently enough: a few sparklers, a string of phooljhadis, children running in circles. Then, as if following some unspoken rule, the neighbourhood decides that peace and quiet are overrated. The polite pops give way to sonic booms, and Powai's skyline begins to resemble a low-budget action film.

This year, the celebrations went on well past midnight. Loud firecrackers reverberated across Mumbai and its suburbs until nearly 2 a.m., with Powai, Andheri, Borivali, Thane and Navi Mumbai among the loudest. The police, perhaps also bitten by the Diwali bug, made no move to reduce their intensity or duration. Residents described this onslaught as a "relentless barrage", the kind that echoed off every building and corner, seeping through even tightly shut windows .

Come 8 p.m. and the air quality had already taken a nosedive. You didn't need an app to tell you that the AQI had entered "don't breathe too deeply" territory, your lungs would have happily confirmed the red reading. A day later, Mumbai's overall AQI crossed 250 in several pockets, squarely in the Poor category, with Powai recording some of the sharpest spikes.

It's not that people don't know better. This is Powai: we conduct composting drives, rally people against use of



plastic, and create resident groups with names like Green Warriors of Lake Boulevard. We discuss sustainability with the same enthusiasm others reserve for cricket scores. But on Diwali night, the invaders arrive. People from other parts of the city pour in with firecrackers, car horns, and zero respect for decibel limits. By midnight, it's less "Festival of Lights" and more "Festival of Smog," and Powai's residents are left peering out from behind their balcony plants, wondering why they bothered sorting their waste all year.

Then there's the great pet panic. Dogs across Hiranandani spend the evening in a state of spiritual crisis. Cats disappear under beds or behind water tanks, plotting revenge. Elderly residents clutch their windowsills, wincing at every boom, while pet owners pace anxiously, armed with calming treats and guilt. One such Powaikar wasn't as lucky: a stray cracker reportedly struck a man on the shoulder before bursting near his ear, leaving him partially deaf . It's the kind of incident that reads like an urban legend until it happens in your lane.

Diwali night in Powai has become an annual test of endurance, how long your patience, pets, air filters and ear drums can hold out. The next day looks like a page out of a war fiction book: streets are littered with red paper, the faint smell of sulphur and clouds of smoke in suspended animation, clinging to the air.

The irony is painful, and a little funny: Powai prides itself on being green, till the festival of lights knocks our doors, and we all choke in style. There are ways to celebrate without summoning spirits from their coffins. Eco-friendly fireworks exist. Silent crackers exist. Even better: conversations exist. Imagine the novelty of actually sharing a meal with your neighbours instead of out-booming them. Powai could do what Powai does best: organise. Resident-only public celebrations, designated "quiet zones," and a polite note to outsiders: please admire from afar; we're breathing here.

If Diwali is truly about light triumphing over darkness, maybe it's time to rethink what kind of light we're spreading. Next year, we can celebrate a little differently. Keep the sweets, keep the diyas, keep the joy: but let's leave behind the fog machines disguised as fireworks.

Hiranandani, you can still sparkle. Just with a bit more conscience….and a bit more oxygen.



From wheat to millets: rediscovering India's ancient superfoods

The Shift in Grains
For decades, wheat and rice dominated Indian plates, seen as the foundation of modern diets. But nutritionists, biologists, and food scientists are now turning the spotlight back on millets- ancient grains once considered "poor man's food" but today hailed as superfoods.

The Science of Why Millets Matter
- Biology of nutrition: Millets are rich in fiber, protein, essential amino acids, and micronutrients like iron, magnesium, and zinc. They support gut health and reduce risks of diabetes and heart disease.

- Chemistry of health: Unlike refined wheat or polished rice, millets have a low glycemic index- meaning they release sugar slowly, preventing sudden spikes in blood glucose. That makes them crucial for India, which is facing rising diabetes cases.

- Environmental science: Millets are climate-resilient crops. They need less water, fewer chemical fertilizers, and withstand droughts better than wheat or rice- making them vital in the face of climate change.

Why It Matters in Mumbai & Powai
- Urban health: Mumbai is witnessing rising lifestyle diseases- obesity, diabetes, hypertension. Powai, with its health-conscious residents, cafes, and restaurants, is seeing a new trend of millet-based dishes. From ragi dosas to bajra rotis and foxtail millet salads, menus are slowly adapting.

- Sustainability: With water scarcity affecting Maharashtra, promoting millets helps reduce agricultural pressure. Farmers in Vidarbha and Marathwada are returning to millet farming, and urban demand plays a huge role.

The Return of Traditional Wisdom
For centuries, communities across India thrived on millets:
- Ragi (finger millet): Strong bones, calcium-rich.
- Jowar (sorghum): Great for digestion, gluten-free.
- Bajra (pearl millet): Keeps you warm, boosts iron levels.
- Foxtail & Little millets: Protein-packed and diabetic-friendly.

What was once seen as "backward" is now seen as the future of sustainable and healthy eating
The Way Forward
- Government push: The Indian government has launched awareness campaigns, school meals, and millet fairs.
- Local startups: Powai's startup ecosystem (around IIT Bombay and Hiranandani) has seen health food brands innovating with millet cookies, granola, and ready-to-cook mixes.

- Community role: Schools, housing societies, and resident associations in Powai can promote millet cooking workshops, food festivals, and weekly millet days.

Conclusion
Switching from wheat and rice dominance to embracing millets isn't just about food trends- it's about better health, sustainable farming,
and reconnecting with India's ancient wisdom. As biologists remind us, the diversity of our diet shapes the diversity of our health. And as chemists explain, the compounds in millets nourish us more completely than polished grains ever could.

For Powai, embracing millets isn't just a return to tradition, it's a leap into a healthier, more sustainable future.

- Anushka Bahorey
Grade 11,
Singapore International School
(Mumbai)



Awake, always: the modern Mumbai story



Girija Menon

Almost 25 years ago—we're talking about a different lifetime, though technically just few calendar pages away—we moved into a suburb called Powai in Mumbai. Back then, Powai was picnic territory. The lake was serene, IIT Mumbai stood tall, and parents whispered proudly that only the best brains studied there. Of course, most of those brains promptly packed their bags and flew west. But that's another story. Probably things will change and those brains will stay back in India because of the many changes the land of dreams is spinning out on a daily basis.

The real beauty of Powai back then? Nature and space at its best. The lake, the horizon beyond, the mountains and the greenery – left, right and centre.
Wide roads you could actually see and feel good about. Today it's to be seen between bumpers. Tall trees meeting at the top to form green tunnels. Gardens that bloomed like Mother Nature was auditioning for a Bollywood set. Joggers ran without dodging bikes, kids cycled without fear, and evening walks felt like…well, evening walks, not obstacle courses.

There were schools, hospitals, shops, and just enough restaurants to keep life lively. Even the mountains at the edge of the skyline had a personality, blushing with clouds that dipped low to kiss their peaks. Powai was charming, breathable, almost romantic in its shade all year round.

Cut to today. Can be said for every suburb in this majestic city, but with a different "progressive" avatar.

The buildings? Taller, shinier, and multiplying like WhatsApp forwards in a family group. The roads? Same width, but now doubling up as parking lots, delivery lanes, and honking arenas. Yes, in a way the parking on some streets have kept the towing vans busy towing away vehicles or pasting tickets for fines that follow the inflation graph to the tee. The gardens? Oh yes, they are there, but as expected crowded and noisier. Shops and showrooms showcasing more brands than we need and more food than we can eat.

And then… the delivery bikes! It's like having a "Delivery Olympics" with Swiggy , Zomato, Blinkit, Burzo and many more jerseys seen on the roads. Neon t-shirts flash by at lightning speed, as if they're competing in the Olympics of Overtaking. Pavements? Ha! Those are now Plan B lanes. If you're over sixty and trying to cross the road, congratulations—you've unlocked "Adventure Sports: Senior Edition."

And the mountains? Hidden. The clouds? Gone. Romance has packed its bags and left to find a more caring lover which in today's scenario is hard to find anywhere.

Progress today most prime they say. However, even AI looks at our pace and says, "You sure you want to continue at this speed"

Groceries in ten minutes, hypertension in five. You can order sushi at 11 p.m., track your rider's heartbeat beside his location in real-time, and still risk being flattened by him if you dare step out for a peaceful walk.

There was a time suburb around Mumbai felt like little pockets of calm. Now, they feel like racetracks with better lighting.

The same story plays out across the "financial capital." Taller towers, faster lives, and attention span shorter than delivery times.

So here we are, applauding convenience while gasping for breath.

Have we traded mountains for malls, clouds for concrete, and peace of mind for "delivered in 30 minutes or free."?

Living in a city that never sleeps, we forgot what dreams were for!





(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)

Pṛthvī to Ākāśa: The Fivefold Foundation of all Creation (Part 4)
Vayu; The carrier of life force

"The wind that bends the forest cannot be seen,

yet all that lives dances to its rhythm" ~ Anonymous



Palak Sardana

These lines capture the essence of Vāyu mahabhuta (air element) perfectly. It is subtle yet extremely powerful as it is the carrier of lifeforce (prāṇa) itself. It can neither be seen nor held but can be felt & is hence associated with the sense of 'Sparsha' (touch). Vāyu comes from the Sanskrit word 'va' which means movement or flow. Within the human body, this element manifests as movement, communication and prāṇa.

An interesting tale about the supremacy of prāṇa as the most pervasive and potent force within all beings comes from the Chhāndogya Upanishad. The story goes that once all the senses- speech, sight, hearing, mind & prana—got into an argument about who was the most powerful of all. Upon Prajapati's advice, they all decided to go on a sabbatical one by one. When the senses and the mind withdrew, though that faculty was absent, yet the life continued. But when prāṇa began to withdraw, all other faculties panicked — speech slurred, sight blurred, hearing dulled & the mind grew unsteady. Realizing that their strength and activity depended on Prāṇa, they pleaded it to stay & honoured it as the supreme sustaining power in all beings upon which all other faculties rested.

We can go without food and water for days, but without the breath, not beyond a few seconds (unless someone is a realised yogi & has mastered the pranic system). The process of respiration is integral to our existence. A person is declared dead or alive depending upon whether they are breathing or not. The whole discipline of pranayama (the 4th limb of ashtanga yoga) is based upon the control and regulation of the pranic body. Through the regulated process of inhalation and exhalation, the prāṇa is channelised within the system. Prāṇa influences specific functions of motion, flow, expansion, contraction & transmission in the body via five sub prāṇas- Prana, Udana, Samana, Apana and Vyana.

In my decades of experience as a practitioner and teacher of yoga, if there is one practice I will cherry pick & prescribe with regards to wellness, it is the practice of pranayama. It is cost, space. time & age effective & is capable of giving incredible results by creating a mind-body harmony & boosting the immune system (that I observed & experienced first-hand during covid). Wellness experts like Dr. Andrew Weil have often endorsed breath work for its remarkable effect on physiology like correcting cardiac arrhythmias, gastrointestinal issues & for effective management of mental health issues like stress & anxiety. He labels breathwork "the natural tranquilizer for the nervous system."

Yoga establishes breath as the link between the mind and the body. The nervous system influences the physiology and in turn the physiology has an effect on the mind. But when the breath is consciously manoeuvred, it brings about a synchronisation between the two hence leading to alignment which is the goal or all yogic practices.

Slow and relaxed diaphragmatic breathing (also called abdominal breathing) creates a quick tranquilising effect for a stressed-out mind & body. Diaphragm is a dome shaped muscle segregating chest cavity from the abdomen. During diaphragmatic breathing, upon inhalation, the diaphragm contracts & the abdomen is pushed out to create space in the chest cavity for the lungs to expand & pull in the air. It is physiologically the most efficient way to breathe as it minimises the use of accessory muscles & increases the oxygen intake. It results in improved oxygenation, lower heart rate & blood pressure, and has a calming effect on the nervous system.

In the Chinese Taoist and Zen practice, the lower Abdomen is called 'dantian' and is considered the seat of life energy (qi). In Japanese Zen, this centre is called 'hara'. Belly breathing is emphasised in both these traditions to acquire calmness of mind & enhanced vitality and awareness.

Out of our naivety and lack of understanding, we have self-sabotaged our health in many ways including the way we breathe. In contemporary culture, flat abdomens have come to be associated with fitness and aesthetics. Many try tucking in their bellies to look physically more appealing. However, this is in complete contrast to efficient breathing which must entail an outer push of the abdomen for engagement of the diaphragm. In its absence, one breathes shallow which shifts the entire system from a relaxed, life-sustaining rhythm to a state of subtle strain & stress.



Nature couldn't have made it any easier by putting the control of the subtle Vāyu tattva right at the tip of your nose. All you need to do is honour nature's intelligence by breathing belly-fully!

(Palak Sardana is a Harvard certified wellness coach, a mental health counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Via these articles, her endeavour is to present non-invasive & practical models of wellness grounded in ancient wisdom and modern scientific research. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

Four foods to a healthy gut



Nisha Singh

The Mumbai monsoon is sure playing hide and seek with us, but the long list of ailments that it inevitably brings with it, are not. Like every year, this year as well cases of gastro and various stomach related infections are on the rise.

This issue I am going to give you five foods, the consumption of which is going to help you in maintaining a healthy gut.



1. Probiotics: Now a days almost everyone is aware about probiotics and their effect on tummy health. Our stomach is home to literally millions of bacteria which keep our stomach and in effect the entire body healthy. It's very crucial to maintain the balance between the good and bad bacteria in our stomach. This delicate balance is often disturbed by stress, infections, antibiotics, inadequate sleep etc. The good bacteria in addition to helping the body generate stools and ridding it of toxins, also helps in the production of various essential vitamins like biotin or vitamin B7, vitamin K, and vitamin B12. The deficiency of these important vitamins can lead to obesity, diabetes, hair loss, grey hair, eczema, ulcers, strokes, cancers, degenerative diseases like Parkinson's and Alzheimer's, gastrointestinal problems etc. but one of the most important functions that these bacteria do for us is boost our immunity. In our gut we most commonly find lactobacilli and bifidobacteria. Homemade curd, kimchi which is fermented cabbage, sourdough bread, certain kinds of cheeses are good sources of probiotics. There are various probiotic drinks also available in the market which are very effective in improving the quality of your gut bacteria.To support probiotics, natural food based prebiotics can also be consumed like onion, asparagus, garlic, honey and bananas. For infants their mother's breast milk is the best probiotic. Research has found that breast fed infants have better immune levels than those that aren't.



2. Carminative herbs: Carminative means herbs that help relieve or prevent the gas and flatulence caused in the stomach due to weak digestion. Herbs like adrak or ginger, pudina or mint, cinnamon or dalchini, ajwain or caraway seeds, saunf or fennel seeds, hing or asafoetida, elaichi or cardamom among several other herbs help to soothe the stomach and ease digestion. Ginger helps to treat nausea and vomiting which can be caused due to infections, pregnancy or chemotherapy. Mint relaxes the stomach muscles and help relieve cramps. Fennel seeds are cooling to the system. Cinnamon helps relieve gas, and also increases the digestive power. Using asafoetida internally or topically both helps release flatulence.The best part is that all these herbs are part of your home kitchen.



3. Oats, leafy vegetables and sabja seeds: Its long been known that oats, leafy vegetables and various other fiber rich foods help the digestive system. But the new research suggests that its helpful effects are not only due to the fiber content but also the fact that they act like a prebiotic. The bacteria present in the stomach feed on the indigestible sugar present in the fiber and play a role in keeping us healthy. Oatmeal and sabja seeds both also acts like a "demulcent" – which means that they form a soothing layer or film over the mucous membrane and so help in relieving pain and inflammation of the stomach lining.

4. Fruits, yellow and green vegetables and fiber: At each meal make a conscious and healthy choice to eat healthy. Select fresh fruits, whole grains, legumes, sprouts, yoghurt, brown rice, healthy oils like mustard oil, sunflower oil, rice bran oil and olive oil. Moderate amounts of eggs, poultry and fish. Nuts and seeds should also be a part of your diet. To satiate the sweet craving opt for dark chocolates. A healthy diet would lead to weight loss which in effect will help to ease the pressure around your abdominal muscles and hence help in relieving pressure on your stomach.

So include these foods in your diet to a healthy gut!!!



You can follow Dietitian Nisha on Instagram for nutrition & fitness tips and live interactive sessions at – nurtiwellness.by.dt.nishas

We at My Powai are taking our readers' queries related to Diet & Nutrition, which Ms. Nisha Singh will reply to in our forthcoming issues.

You can send your questions at: dietnutrition.queries@gmail.com

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Food to elevate your mood



Chef Sudhir Pai

I've always believed that vegetarian cuisine has a unique charm that can truly tickle the taste buds. Here are two dishes and a snack that are not only delicious but also simple to prepare. I'm sure most of you are already familiar with these dishes, but try them using my recipe and let me know how tasty they turn out.

Bharleli Wangi

Maharashtrian style stuffed brinjals



Eggplant small – 8 to 10 nos

For the stuffing

- Peanut crushed – 1 tbsp.
- Jeera – 1 tsp.
- Teel (sesame seeds) – 2 tbsp.
- Fresh grated coconut – a cup
- Turmeric – ½ tsp.
- Chilli pd – 1tspn
- Goda masala – 2 tsp.
- Salt – ½ tsp.
- Garlic – 4 cloves
- Ginger – 1 inch piece
- Tamarind – 1 marble size pc
- Coriander seeds 2 tbsp.
- Onion finely chopped – 1 no

For the gravy

- Oil – 2 tbsp.
- Mustard seeds – 11/2 tsp.
- Cumin seeds – 1tspn
- Hing – 1 pinch
- Chilli pd – 1 tsp.
- Turmeric pd – ¼ tsp.
- Salt-to taste
- Jaggery – 1 tsp.
- Chopped coriander leaves – 1 tbsp.

Method

1.Take 8 to 10 small eggplant and slit them in the centre and keep in water to avoid discolouration

2.Mix all the filling ingredients together after roasting them a bit individually on a low flame.

3.Masala powders to be added last and make into a coarse paste and then add sautéed onion to it.

4.Fill the coarse paste filling into the eggplant which is slit (make sure they are out of water and dried), keep the extra masala on the side.

5.Now to prepare the gravy, heat oil in a kadai and add mustard,jeera, when they splutter add hing and add turmeric and chilli powder, make sure the flame is low

6.Now add leftover stuffing fry for a minute and add stuffed eggplant one by one and gently mix them so that all are cooked evenly on all sides.

7.Sprinkle a little water cover the lid and cook for slow fire for 5 minutes.

8.Open the lid and keep stirring, add salt, jaggery grated and tamarind pulp so that the one on top go below and all get evenly cooked

9.Further cover the lid and cook for 4 minutes.

10. Check whether the eggplants are cooked, sprinkle with chopped coriander leaves and serve hot with phulkas,chapati or rice

Kurkure Bhindi

Crispy fried lay fingers



- Tender ladies' finger – 250 gms
- Chilli powder – 1tspn
- Turmeric pd – ½ tsp.
- Cumin powder – ½ tsp.
- Chaat masala – ½ tsp.
- Salt to taste
- ½ cup besan
- 1/4th cup rice flour
- 2 tsp. oil
- Chaat masala – for sprinkling

Method

1.Wash and pat dry lady's finger

2.Once they ae completely dry, cut them lengthwise into thin strips

3.Sprinkle all the masala powders over the cut bhindi, and mix gently making sure they are coated in masala evenly and keep aside for 5 minutes

4.Now sprinkle salt, besan and rice flour and 2 tbsp. of oil and mix them well.

5.Don't add any water, the lady's finger will automatically release moisture and they will get a nice coating.

6.Deep fry in medium hot oil to nice and golden

7.Drain them on a paper towel and serve hot sprinkled with chaat masala powder.

8.Can be served as a side dish with meals or even as an appetizer.

Vazhaipoo Vadai

Banana flower & lentil fritters



- Finely chopped Banana flowers – 1 ½ cup
- Buttermilk – 3 cups
- chana dal – 1 cup
- Roasted chana dal – 2 tbsp
- Dried red chilli – 4nos
- Green chilies – 2
- Saunf – 1tsp.
- Jeera – 1 tsp.
- Onion finelychopped – 1 medium size
- Asafoetida– a pinch
- Salt – to taste
- Curry leaves – two sprigs
- Chopped coriander leaves –2 tbsp.
- Oil – to deep fry

Method

1.Wash and soak channadal in water for about 2 hours.

2.Clean and remove the flowers from the banana pod,

3. Chop them into fine pieces and keep them immersed in buttermilk to avoid discolouration till u use them

4.In a mixer jar, add the soaked and drained lentils, green chilies, red chilies, salt, hing and roast channa dal, jeera and saunf, justa few times to make a coarse paste.

5.Next add the chopped banana flowers (make sure they are drain well before adding), onion, chopped coriander, and fennel seeds just few times to mix well.

6.Add curry leaves to the batter and mix well, make small balls and shape them flat like a tikki.

7.Fry them in medium hot oil till golden brown, serve with spicy coconut chutney or any hot sauce.

(Chef Sudhir Pai is a celebrated name in the F&B space with decades of experience in his portfolio. Right from working at the best hotels to creating iconic food brands to creating D2C packaged food brands to setting the perfect processes in all scales of food businesses, there is nothing in the F&B space he can't do. A people's person at heart, he has a great network of industry specialists and aces the role of consulting dozens of brands on their way to success. No project is impossible for his extensive skill set and expertise.web: www.chefspai.com email: chefpai73@yahoo.co.in)

November 2025



Richa Pathak

Aries (Mar 21 – Apr 19) This month encourages strategic moves over spontaneous leaps. Focus on long-term gains instead of short-term excitement. You may find renewed motivation to chase an old goal. Relationships stabilize as communication clears. **Lucky Color:** Crimson **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** Keep a small copper pyramid on your study table or work desk to channel Mars energy into discipline and success.

Taurus (Apr 20 – May 20)
Your focus shifts toward security and emotional comfort. It's a good month to balance indulgence with practicality. A family member's advice can bring surprising clarity in finances. Stay patient—slow progress is still progress. **Lucky Color:** Dusty Rose **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Write your gratitude list on pink paper every Friday evening and keep it in your wardrobe to enhance Venus blessings.

Gemini (May 21 – Jun 20)
November sharpens your intellect and brings opportunities to reconnect with people who inspire growth. Your ideas will be noticed—so speak with confidence. Avoid mental clutter and overstimulation. **Lucky Color:** Sky Blue **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Place a feather or wind chime near your window to invite Mercury's light, free-flowing communication energy.

Cancer (Jun 21 – Jul 22)
Emotional growth and introspection define your month. You may revisit past choices with a softer heart and new understanding. Financially, it's time to save rather than spend. Home improvements bring joy. **Lucky Color:** Silver Grey **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Keep a white seashell bowl filled with rock salt in your bedroom for emotional cleansing and better sleep.

Leo (Jul 23 – Aug 22)
A confident and focused you emerges this month. Your hard work finally begins to gain attention. Creative projects sparkle with potential. Just avoid pride—collaboration brings faster results than solo efforts. **Lucky Color:** Amber Gold **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Place a small mirror on the east wall of your workspace to reflect light and amplify recognition energy.

Virgo (Aug 23 – Sep 22)
Health, habits, and organization come into sharp focus. You'll crave structure but may need to release perfectionism. An old connection could help professionally. Stay flexible and you'll achieve more than planned. **Lucky Color:** Olive Green **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Keep a few basil leaves in your wallet (wrapped in paper) to attract stability and steady progress.



Libra (Sep 23 – Oct 22)
Relationships take center stage this month—especially how you balance giving and receiving. Your charm is magnetic, making this a wonderful time for teamwork or negotiation. Avoid comparing your path to others. **Lucky Color:** Peach **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Add a small crystal bowl with rose petals and water in your living room to maintain harmony and emotional flow.

Scorpio (Oct 23 – Nov 21)
Your transformative streak continues. You're letting go of past fears and embracing self-worth. Financial renewal is possible through smart decision-making. Trust your gut—it's sharper than logic now. **Lucky Color:** Deep Burgundy **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Burn bay leaves with your written worries once a week to symbolically release emotional toxins.

Sagittarius (Nov 22 – Dec 21)
You feel a burst of optimism after a slow phase. New learning, travel, or collaborations may appear. Keep your enthusiasm grounded—discipline will make your vision real. **Lucky Color:** Indigo **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Keep a citrine or yellow topaz crystal near your bedside to boost Jupiter's wisdom and attract abundance.

Capricorn (Dec 22 – Jan 19)
Responsibility is your strength this month. You'll be managing multiple priorities successfully if you pace yourself. Health and rest need attention—avoid burnout. A mentor's words could shift your direction positively. **Lucky Color:** Charcoal Grey **Lucky Day:** Saturday **Remedy:** Write your week's goals on a square piece of paper every Saturday and place it under a black stone till completion.

Aquarius (Jan 20 – Feb 18)
This is a month of innovative ideas and social progress. Your originality attracts the right allies. Stay humble even as appreciation grows. Health improves with hydration and mindful breaks. **Lucky Color:** Electric Blue **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Keep a bowl of clean water in the north zone of your home to activate clarity and intuitive strength.

Pisces (Feb 19 – Mar 20)
Your sensitivity turns into strength this month. Dreams, spirituality, and intuition guide you through life's crossroads. Artistic work or meditation will bring calm and purpose. Avoid emotional overspending. **Lucky Color:** Aqua Green **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Before sleeping, place a few drops of rosewater on your pillow for peace, divine dreams, and emotional healing.

Final Words:
November 2025 carries a quiet but powerful message—reset, reorganize, and realign. Trust the process, nurture what matters, and prepare your spirit for the transformation that awaits in December.

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)